



MARRIOTT

Marriott International Market Research Proposal

(ST3188 Coursework 2025)

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Marriott International is a global hospitality company headquartered in Maryland, United States. It operates nearly 9,000 properties across 141 countries and territories with around 30 brands, including Marriott, Sheraton, and The Ritz-Carlton. Marriott is currently the top hotel chain in the world. The company seeks to expand its global footprint through acquisitions and partnerships. With a focus on delivering exceptional guest experiences, while taking social responsibility and reducing environmental impact.

This study aims to help Marriott International in achieving its goal by addressing four main research aims (RA) that are identified in the client brief.

1. Understanding customer preferences for personalised services and technological integration
2. Identify emerging travel trends and destination hotspots and preferences of different demographic segments
3. Determine the effectiveness of their loyalty programs and guest satisfaction across different brands and regions
4. Investigate the impact of sustainability initiatives on customer loyalty, and understanding economic factors that influence travel behaviour to adapt to a dynamic market

After we identified the four research aims (RA), we propose research questions (RQ) and research objectives (RO) to explore the areas to conduct in-depth analysis to address Marriotts aims and concerns. The next step would be to explain the methodology of this study which includes the research design structure, the sampling method proposed, what data is required to collect and how the data collection is conducted. Additionally, a flow chart of the study will be provided for the client. Next, we explain the statistical techniques proposed to analyse data and insights from each analysis. We will also discuss the method of focus group discussion (FGD) and the recommended sample questions.

The other important information such as screenshots of the proposed questionnaire and interest form, Gantt chart of our timeframe and budget for the entire research project will be provided.

Our goal is to provide Marriott International with the best recommendation and explore perspectives of customers based on the analysis. We believe our work is imperative in Marriott International's mission to expand global presence.

Table of Contents

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY	2
1. Introduction	5
1. Background	5
1.2 Problem Definition	5
1.3 Research Aims (RA).....	5
1.4 Research Questions (RQ) and Research Objective (RO)	6
2. Methodology and data collection	7
2.1 Research design and approach	7
2.2 Sample size	7
2.3 Marriott customers	8
2.4 Non-Marriott customers	8
2.5 Factors to consider when selecting participants	8
2.6 Questionnaire	9
2.7 Focus group discussion (FGD)	9
2.8 Flow chart	10
2.9 Data collected	11
3. Data analysis and interpretation of results.....	12
3.1 Research Objective 1.1	13
3.2 Research Objective 1.2	14
3.3 Research Objective 2.2	16
3.4 Research Objective 3.1	18
3.5 Research Objective 3.2	20
3.6 Research Objective 4.1	22
3.7 Research Objective 4.2	24
3.8 Research Objective 2.1(Focus Group Discussion)	26
4.Questionnaire	27
4.1 Main Questionnaire	27
4.2 Questionnaire for Marriott Customers	29
4.3 Questionnaire for Non-Marriot Customers	31
4.4 Interest form for Focus Group Discussion	32
5. Proposed timeline	33

6. Budget	33
7.Recommendations	34
8. Appendix.....	34
9. Fulfilment of proposal requirements	35

1. Introduction

1. Background

As the top hotel chain in the world, Marriott International operates nearly 9,000 properties across 141 countries and territories with around 30 brands, including Marriott, Sheraton, and The Ritz-Carlton. The company aims to expand their global presence by increasing hotel properties and enhancing brand diversity.

1.2 Problem Definition

The client's brief mentioned Marriott International's business objective in driving growth through acquisitions, franchise development and partnerships. It also aims to enhance guest experience by leveraging technology and personalised services, whilst prioritising sustainability and social responsibility. Lastly, they seek innovation, operational efficiency and a strong brand portfolio. This study will address these concerns within a six-month window to provide Marriott International with strategies in this dynamic market. Essentially to sustain their competitive position.

1.3 Research Aims (RA)

From the client brief, we will focus on four main research aims to assist Marriott International in addressing their concerns.

RA1: We want to accurately understand customer preferences for personalised services and technology integration to improve customer(guest) experience.

RA2: We want to identify emerging travel trends, popular destination hotspots, and preferences of different demographic segments

RA3: We want to assess the effectiveness of Marriott International's loyalty programs and guest satisfaction across the different brands and regions.

RA4: We want to analyse the impact of sustainability initiatives on customer loyalty and how economic factors affect travel behaviour to adapt to a dynamic market.

1.4 Research Questions (RQ) and Research Objective (RO)

To further our understanding of each research aim, we proposed research questions, followed by research objectives.

1) For RA1:

RQ 1.1: How does guest preferences for personalised services differ across gender?

RQ 1.2: How does technology integration impact guest satisfaction?

ROs proposed:

RO 1.1: Examine the relationship between gender and the different preferences for personalised services.

RO 1.2: Examine the relationship between different age groups and preference for technological integration

2) For RA2:

RQ 2.1: What are the emerging travel trends and popular destinations that influence booking decisions for hotels.

RQ 2.2: How does the customer's likelihood of staying in a Marriott hotel differ by the following variables: Gender, Age, Employability status, Income level ,Travel size, Travel purpose, Region of residence.

ROs proposed:

RO 2.1: Investigate emerging travel trends, patterns and popular destinations, and how they affect customer's decision in selecting a hotel.

RO 2.2: Examine the relationship between the above mentioned variables and customer's likelihood of staying in a Marriott hotel.

3) For RA3:

RQ 3.1: How do guest satisfaction levels vary across different Marriott brands and regions?

RQ 3.2: Are the loyalty programs increasing guest retention and satisfaction at a Marriott Hotel?

ROs proposed:

RO 3.1: Examine how guest satisfaction differs across different Marriott brands and regions.

RO 3.2: Examine the relationship customer likelihood of repeat bookings at a Marriott Hotel across different loyalty membership tiers.

4) For RA4:

RQ 4.1: How do Marriott's sustainability initiatives influence customer loyalty?

RQ 4.2: How does economic factors influence booking decisions and travel trends?

ROs proposed:

RO 4.1: Examine the relationship between awareness of Marriott's sustainability initiatives and customer's likelihood of repeat bookings.

RO 4.2: Examine the relationship between economic factors and customer decision to book a budget accommodation. (e.g. Economic conditions, income level, currency exchange rates)

2. Methodology and data collection

2.1 Research design and approach

In this research, we will use a combination of exploratory, descriptive and causal designs to retrieve the information needed to answer our research objectives. Exploratory designs retrieve relevant information to the RO and identify patterns due to lack of information for decision making.

Descriptive ROs are to describe market characteristics and behaviours in a population, providing detailed understanding of a phenomenon. Causal ROs aim to examine cause and effect between variables.

2.2 Sample size

Marriott International is looking at a sample of at least 5000 existing customers globally, segmented appropriately. At 95% confidence interval (5% significance level), a standard deviation of 0.5, and a margin of error of +/- 5%, using the formula below to determine the minimum required sample size:

$$n \geq \frac{Z_{\alpha/2}^2 (\pi(1 - \pi))}{e^2}$$

$$n \geq \frac{1.96^2 (0.5(1 - 0.5))}{0.05^2} \approx 385$$

From the formula, we can generate the minimum sample size of 385 respondents that will finish the questionnaire. A larger sample size will be much more costly despite better representation of population. However, if more participants join, sample size will increase.

Although the latest report in 2024 shows that Marriott International's revenue is led by APEC ¹, but from 2016-2023, U.S has been the largest revenue contributor account for 82% while remainder is from other regions ². As such, we will sample the 385 Marriott customers according to 2016-2023.

¹ Quoted from Marriott investor relations annual report 2024

² Quoted from Business Quant – Marriott international revenue breakdown 2016-2023

According to statista.com, a study in the U.S. estimated approximately 19% of hotel customers had stayed in a Marriott hotel before, while the other 81% have not stayed in a Marriott hotel yet ³.

Based on the data, we would expect the number of non-Marriott customers who participate in the study to be around 81% of hotel customers. Assuming Marriott chooses to follow through with 385 existing Marriott customers, we can expect around 73 non-Marriott customers to do the questionnaire.

2.3 Marriott customers

Since sampling of Marriott customers will be provided by Marriott International's marketing database (secondary data), we will use stratified random sampling to select respondents from their database. Examining the demographic groups, dividing the customers (population) into distinct subgroups (strata). A sample will be selected probabilistically from each subgroup. The sampling method will ensure proper representation of the subgroups and allows us to have better comparisons between the subgroups.

2.4 Non-Marriott customers

We will use convenience sampling (non-probability sampling) since there is no sampling of non-Marriott customers. This sampling method is not only easy to implement, but also fast and economical. It does not require complex sampling procedures. However, the sample can be biased in its findings as it may not be representative of the whole population. The sample method will also have reduced statistical precision in its findings.

2.5 Factors to consider when selecting participants

This participants should have some knowledge of hotels and experienced staying at hotels more than a few times before. They should be at least 18 years old. This ensures better responses for data collection. Basic computer literacy and internet access should be expected. As the questionnaires and online focus group discussions can be done at any region, translation will be provided for the native language of the participant.

³ Quoted from Statista – Marriott brand profile in the United States 2023

2.6 Questionnaire

Online questionnaire is convenient, inexpensive, allows for geographic flexibility, and data collection is almost instantaneous. The questionnaire explains the purpose and importance of the survey. Question types such as ranking, scale and preference is used. Afterwards, respondents will proceed to their respective customer sections (Marriott customer/ Non-Marriott customer). As Marriott International has a large budget, we will provide an incentive : PayPal gift cards. The incentive is to boost response rate and quality.

Pilot-testing will be conducted from a small sample of 30 respondents from sampling frame. The goal is to spot any potential errors in the questionnaire that we might have missed making the questionnaire. The pilot-test will ensure respondents will have little-to-no doubt and no difficulty when reading and answering the questions.

The questionnaire will be distributed through emails, social media, Marriott hotel's websites, and at Marriott hotels. Respondents who choose to participate in Focus group discussion by filling the FGD interest form will receive additional gift cards. They will be given ample time to prepare, as the topic of discussion will be sent to their contact/ email.

2.7 Focus group discussion (FGD)

The purpose of an online focus group discussion is to explore customer's perspective in choosing a hotel. Online focus group discussions is less pressuring and allows participants to be in the comfort of their own place. The discussions will be carried out with respondents who filled the FGD interest form after the previous online questionnaire.

Online data suggests that focus groups should be conducted with 10 participants and 1 moderator, as any more will be increasingly difficult to moderate . Additionally 6 focus groups and above are ideal in retrieving sufficient information ⁴.

Thus, I propose 10 focus groups (5 Marriott customers and 5 Non-Marriott customers). The focus group discussion will be held at maxed 90 minutes ⁵, done across a period of 2 weeks with 1 focus group every weekday. The moderator will be given a list of questions to follow. Respondents will be filtered if more than 200 applicants filled out the FGD form. A similar pilot-testing will also be conducted with a few groups of 5 respondents.

⁴ Quoted from Participants in a focus group, n.d.

⁵ Quoted from Nottingham Spirk – How long should a focus group last?

2.8 Flow chart

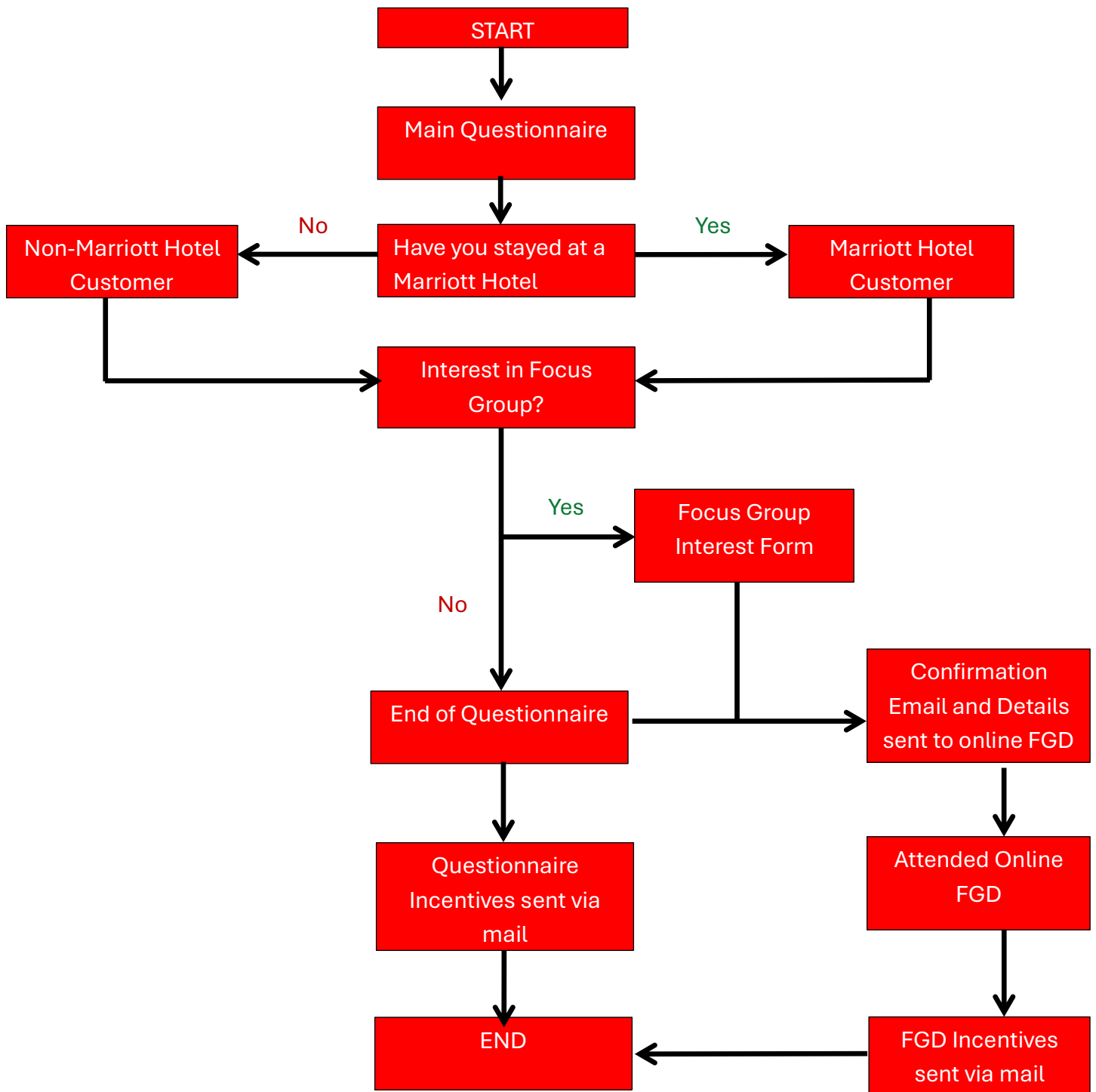


Figure 1: Flow chart to illustrate the start and end of the data collection process using questionnaire and focus group discussion

2.9 Data collected

No.	Variable	Data type	Method of data collection
1	Gender	Categorical Nominal	Survey
2	Age group	Categorical Ordinal	Survey
3	Employability status	Categorical Nominal	Survey
4	Income level	Categorical Ordinal	Survey
5	Travel size	Categorical Ordinal	Survey
6	Travel purpose	Continuous	Survey
7	Region of residence	Categorical Nominal	Survey
8	Brands of Marriott hotels	Categorical Nominal	Survey
9	Regions with Marriott hotels	Categorical Nominal	Survey
10	Loyalty tier	Categorical Ordinal	Survey
11	Awareness of sustainability	Categorical Nominal	Survey
12	Economic status	Categorical Nominal	Survey
13	Preference of personalised services	Categorical Ordinal	Survey - Ranking
14	Technology integration rating	Continuous	Survey – Likert Scale (1-5) And Ranking
15	Likelihood of booking at a Marriot hotel	Categorical Nominal	Survey – Likert Scale (1-5) And Ranking

16	Guest satisfaction rating	Continuous	Survey – Likert Scale (1-5) And Ranking
17	Likelihood of repeat bookings	Categorical Nominal	Survey – Likert Scale (1-5) And Ranking
18	Preference of budget accommodation	Categorical Nominal	Survey
19	Emerging travel trend and destination hotspots		Focus Groups

Primary data is collected through focus group discussions and online questionnaires, and secondary data will be provided by the Marriott International database.

3. Data analysis and interpretation of results

The research proposed is a mixture of quantitative and qualitative analysis. For quantitative analysis, hypothesis will be proposed for each research objective which requires statistical analysis and testing, while quantitative data is collected through online surveys. For qualitative analysis, research will be carried out with online Focus group discussions to gather participant responses.

Qualitative:

RO 2.1: Focus group (for Marriott customers and Non-Marriott customers)

Quantitative:

RO 1.1: χ^2 Test of independence

RO 1.2: 1-way ANOVA

RO 2.2: Multiple linear regression

RO 3.1: 2-way ANOVA

RO 3.2: 1-way ANOVA

RO 4.1: Independent t-test

RO 4.2: 2-Group Discriminant Analysis

3.1 Research Objective 1.1

χ^2 Test of independence will be useful in addressing this objective. The independent variable is gender of customers while the dependent variable is preferred personalisation services. We want to determine if there is a relationship between the two variables. As such we will use a contingency table below:

Count		Personalization services					Total
		Personalized Room services	Personalized dining experiences	Service delivery quality	Personalised Room settings	Personal concierge services	
Gender	Male						
	Female						
Total							

Table 2: Contingency Table Cross tabulation of Preferred Personalisation services against Gender

To test :

- H_0 : There is no association between gender and preferred personalisation services
- H_1 : There is association between gender and preferred personalisation services

Chi-Square Tests

	Value	df	Asymptotic Significance (2-sided)
Pearson Chi-Square			
Likelihood Ratio			
Linear-by-Linear Association			
N of Valid Cases			

Table 3: Chi-Square Tests table from SPSS

From the Chi-Square test table, we obtain the p-value from “Asymptotic Significance (2-sided) “ * “ Pearson Chi-Square “ box. If p-value < 0.05, reject H_0 and conclude that there is an association between gender of guests and preferred personalisation services.

3.2 Research Objective 1.2

1 way ANOVA will be suitable in addressing this objective. With the customer age group as the independent variable while the technological integration rating as the dependent variable, we want to test if technological integration rating differs across customer age groups.

Customer's age group
• Baby boomers (1946-1964) • Generation X (1965-1980) • Millennials (1981-1996) • Generation Z (1997-2012)

Table 4: Classification of Independent variable

Test of between subject effects

Source	N	Mean	Std. Deviation	Std. Error	Lower bound	Upper bound	Minimum	Maximum
Baby boomers (1946-1964)								
Generation X (1965-1980)								
Millennials (1981-1996)								
Generation Z (1997-2012)								
Total								

Table 5: Descriptives

Technological integration rating	Levene Statistic	Df1	Df2	Sig.
Based on Mean				
Based on Median				
Based on Median and with adjusted df				
Based on trimmed mean				

Table6: Test of homogeneity of Variances

Levene's Test

$$H_0: \sigma_1^2 = \sigma_2^2$$

$$H_1: \sigma_1^2 \neq \sigma_2^2$$

Levene's test is conducted to test for homogeneity of variances for the dependent variable. H_0 will be rejected if the p-value < 0.05. This concludes that the population variances for technological integration rating for the age groups customers are significantly different.

ANOVA

Technological integration rating	Sum of squares	df	Mean square	F	Sig.
Between groups					
Within groups					
Total					

Table 7: 1-way ANOVA Table from SPSS

To test :

- H_0 : There is no difference in the population mean of the technological integration rating among age groups
- H_1 : Not all means are equal

From 1-way ANOVA table, the p-value is obtained from Sig. column. If p-value < 0.05, reject H_0 and conclude that there is an association between age group of guests and preference of technological integration.

3.3 Research Objective 2.2

Multiple linear regression is suitable in addressing RO2.2. The predictor variables as gender, age group, annual income, employability, travel purpose, travel size and region of residence. The dependent variable will be the likelihood to book at a Marriott hotel.

$$\text{Willingness to pay} = \beta_0 + \beta_1(\text{Gender}) + \beta_2(\text{Age Group}) + \beta_3(\text{Annual Income}) + \beta_4(\text{Employability}) + \beta_5(\text{Travel Purpose}) + \beta_6(\text{Travel Size}) + \beta_7(\text{Region of Residence}) + \epsilon_i$$

β_0 : The intercept (the value of Likelihood of Booking at a Marriott Hotel when all the Xs are 0).

β_j : The amount by which Likelihood of Booking at Marriott Hotel changes when X_j increases by one unit, with the values of all independent variables held constant ($j = 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7$.)

Coefficients

Model	Unstandardized Coefficients		Standardized Coefficients	t	Sig.	95.0% Confidence Interval for B	
	Beta	Std. Error	Beta			Lower Bound	Upper Bound
1(Constant)							
Gender							
Age group							
Annual Income							
Employability							
Travel purpose							
Travel size							
Region of residence							

Table 8: Coefficients table of likelihood of booking at Marriott Hotel from SPSS

The coefficients in the table is derived from unstandardized coefficients in the Beta column. Using partial t-test by comparing the Sig. value against 0.05, we can determine significance of each independent variable. If p-value < 0.05, conclude that the variable is a significant predictor.

Model Summary

Model	R	R Square	Adjusted R square	Std. Error of the Estimate
1				

Table 9: Model summary for model fit from SPSS

The strength of association in the multiple regression model is measured through R^2 . The larger the R^2 , the more accurately predicted effect of each independent variable on the customer's likelihood of booking at a Marriott Hotel. Using ANOVA table, we conduct a global F-test to find out if all the Independent variables have zero regression coefficients.

ANOVA

	Sum of squares	df	Mean square	F	Sig.
Regression					*
Residual					
Total					

Table 10: ANOVA for Global F-test from SPSS

$H_0: \beta_1=\beta_2=\beta_3=\beta_4=\beta_5=\beta_6=\beta_7=0$ against $H_1: \text{Not all } \beta s \text{ are } 0$. If the p-value denoted by * is less than 0.05, we reject H_0 and conclude that some of the independent variables is capable of explaining the variation in the dependent variable.

3.4 Research Objective 3.1

2-way ANOVA will be used to address this objective. Independent variables are brands of Marriott and Region. The dependent variable is the guest satisfaction rating. We want to test is the guest satisfaction rating differs across Marriott brands and region.

Brand	Region
• Ritz-Carlton, St Regis, JW Marriott (Luxury) • Marriott Hotels, Sheraton, Westin (Premium) • Courtyard, Fairfield Inn & Suites, Moxy Hotel (Service hotels)	• APEC • EMEA • USA

Table 11: Classification of variables

Tests of between-subject effects

Source	Sum of square	df	Mean square	F	Sig	Partial eta squared (η^2)
Corrected Model						
Intercept						
Brand						
Region						
Brand*Region						
Error						
Total						
Corrected Total						

Table 12: 2-way ANOVA table from SPSS

Main Effect

	Brand	Region	Interaction Variable
H_0	There is no difference in the population mean of the guest satisfaction rating across brands	There is no difference in the population mean of the guest satisfaction rating across regions	There is no interaction between brand and region
H_1	Not all means are equal	Not all means are equal	There is interaction between brand and region

Table 13: Summary of null and alternative hypothesis for 2-way ANOVA

P-value is obtained from Sig column. H_0 will be rejected if the p-value obtained are less than 0.05.

Furthermore, η^2 will measure the strength of effects (total variation in the guest satisfaction rating) of each independent variable that is not attributable to other variables bolded in the , η^2 column.

3.5 Research Objective 3.2

1 way ANOVA will be suitable in addressing this objective. With the loyalty tiers as the independent variable while the likelihood of repeat bookings at a Marriott hotel as the dependent variable, we want to test if likelihood of repeat bookings differ across loyalty tiers.

Loyalty tier
• Silver elite • Gold elite • Platinum elite • Titanium elite • Ambassador elite • Non-member

Table 14: Classification of Independent variable

Test of between subject effects

	N	Mean	Std. Deviation	Std. Error	Lower bound	Upper bound	Minimum	Maximum
Silver elite								
Gold elite								
Platinum elite								
Titanium elite								
Ambassador elite								
Non-member								
Total								

Table 15: Descriptives

Likelihood of repeat bookings	Levene Statistic	Df1	Df2	Sig.
Based on Mean				
Based on Median				
Based on Median and with adjusted df				
Based on trimmed mean				

Table16: Test of homogeneity of Variances

Levene's Test

$$H_0: \sigma_1^2 = \sigma_2^2$$

$$H_1: \sigma_1^2 \neq \sigma_2^2$$

Levene's test is conducted to test for homogeneity of variances for the dependent variable. H_0 will be rejected if the p-value < 0.05. This concludes that the population variances for likelihood of repeat bookings and loyalty tier are significantly different.

ANOVA

Likelihood of repeat bookings	Sum of squares	df	Mean square	F	Sig.
Between groups					
Within groups					
Total					

Table 17: 1-way ANOVA Table from SPSS

To test :

- H_0 : There is no difference in the population mean of likelihood of repeat bookings among loyalty tiers
- H_1 : Not all means are equal

From 1-way ANOVA table, the p-value is obtained from Sig. column. If p-value < 0.05, reject H_0 and conclude that there is an association between likelihood of repeat bookings and loyalty tiers.

3.6 Research Objective 4.1

Independent T-test will be utilised in addressing RO4.1. With the awareness of sustainability initiatives as the independent variable while likelihood of repeat bookings at a Marriott hotel as the dependent variable. We want to test if likelihood of repeat bookings differ between customers aware and unaware of sustainability initiatives.

Symbol	Denotes
σ_1^2	Population variance of likelihood of repeat bookings of customers aware of sustainability initiatives
σ_2^2	Population variance of likelihood of repeat bookings of customers unaware of sustainability initiatives
μ_1	Population mean of likelihood of repeat bookings of customers aware of sustainability initiatives
μ_2	Population mean of likelihood of repeat bookings of customers unaware of sustainability initiatives

Table 18: Variance denotation for independent t-test

Independent Samples Test

		Levene's Test for Equality of Variances					t-test for Equality of Means		95% Confidence Interval of the Difference	
		F	Sig.	t	df	Sig. (2-tailed)	Mean Difference	Std. Error Difference	Lower	Upper
Likelihood of repeat stays	Equal variances assumed									
	Equal variances not assumed									

Table 19: Independent samples test from SPSS

Levene's Test

$$H_0: \sigma_1^2 = \sigma_2^2$$

$$H_1: \sigma_1^2 \neq \sigma_2^2$$

Levene's test is conducted to test for homogeneity of variances for the dependent variable. H_0

will be rejected if the p-value < 0.05. This concludes that the population variances for likelihood of repeat bookings and awareness of sustainability initiatives are significantly different.

Independent T-Test

$$H_0: \mu_1 - \mu_2 = 0$$

$$H_1: \mu_1 - \mu_2 \neq 0$$

H_0 will be rejected if the value in Sig.(2 tailed) column_(Levene's test) < 0.05. This concludes that the mean likelihood of repeat bookings is different between customers aware and not aware of sustainability initiatives. Additionally, if the lower and upper bound of the confidence interval both shows positive values, this exhibits that the mean of customers unaware of sustainability initiatives is higher than that of customers aware of sustainability initiatives.

3.7 Research Objective 4.2

2-group Discriminant Analysis will be used for RO4.2. Let the predictor variable be the current economic conditions, seasonal fluctuations in hotel rates, income level of customers , currency exchange rate. The dependent variable is the customer preference of budget accommodations.

The discriminant function is:

$$\hat{D} = \hat{\alpha}_0 + \hat{\alpha}_1 (EC) + \hat{\alpha}_2 (SF) + \hat{\alpha}_3 (IL) + \hat{\alpha}_4 (CE)$$

$\hat{D}$: Discriminant score

$\hat{\alpha}_k$: Discriminant Coefficient for variables k

EC: Economic condition

SF: Seasonal fluctuations in Hotel rates

IL: Income level of customers

CE: Currency exchange rate

Canonical Discriminant Function Coefficients

Function 1

Economic condition	
Seasonal fluctuations in hotel rates	
Income level of customers	
Currency exchange rate	
(constant)	

Table 20: Canonical Discriminant Function Coefficients from SPSS

The coefficients of the discriminant function is obtained using Table 20 and the significance of each predictor will be assessed using a series of univariate ANOVAs using Wilks' Lambda and p-value (shown in table 21).

Test of Equality of Group Means

	Wilk's Lambda	F	df1	df2	Sig.
Economic condition					
Seasonal fluctuations in hotel rates					
Income level of customers					
Currency exchange rate					

Table 21: Tests of Equality of Group Means from SPSS

If the p-value < 0.05, it means that the predictor is statistically significant. Thus we would prefer smaller Wilks' Lambda (or higher F value) as value closer to 0 indicates better discriminatory ability. We can also refer from another table called "Structure Matrix" which measures the correlation between each predictor and the discriminant function. Higher correlation is preferred.

The suitability of the discriminant function is measured through "Eigenvalues" and "Wilks' Lambda" table. The larger Eigenvalue signifies stronger discrimination, as it shows a large canonical correlation, indicating a high discriminating power between two groups. Wilks' Lambda assesses the significance of this canonical correlation, value closer to 0 is preferred.

With the discrimination function, a "Classification Results" table will be generated. We can calculate the improvement over chance by calculating the hit ratio then deduct it by 50% (expected hit ratio of 2 groups of equal sizes).

The results will give us insight of which variables would attract customers to choose a budget accommodation.

3.8 Research Objective 2.1 (Focus Group Discussion)

We will use Focus group discussions to address RO2.1. Details of participants, moderators and running time are already mentioned in section 2.7.

The FGD gains insight into whether travellers select destination first over hotel, or vice versa. More importantly it helps Marriott understand if they are aligned with travellers needs and expectations, and how to improve. Existing Marriott-Hotel customers can share on how emerging travel trends affect their loyalty and why they choose Marriott over competitors. Non-Marriott customers can provide reasons into why they choose competitors over Marriott, such as not meeting travellers expectations in the destination hotspots. Ultimately, we can uncover features Marriott hotels are lagging in comparison to competitors, but also understand what Marriott hotel features that entice existing customers even in trending destinations.

The moderator will ask questions to probe discussion such as “ How do social media and influencers affect your decision for destinations and hotels?” and “ Do you prefer staying in hotels that are located in destination hotspots, and what is the factors in your decision making?”.

4.Questionnaire

4.1 Main Questionnaire

Questionnaire for Marriott Hotel Market Research

Marriott International operates nearly 9,000 properties across 141 countries and territories with around 30 brands, including Marriott, Sheraton, and The Ritz-Carlton. With a focus on exceptional quality service and guest experience, Marriott International is looking for respondents to gather insight on how to improve our service. Your response is crucial and we would like to consider your opinion by filling out this questionnaire which will take around 10-15 minutes. As a reward, you will be given \$10 USD PayPal Voucher via email upon completion.

bryonwongultra@gmail.com [Switch account](#)

 Not shared

Full Name

Your answer

Year of birth

Your answer

What is your gender?

☐ Male

☐ Female

Which of the following is your permanent residence of birth?

☐ US

☐ Europe

☐ Asia Pacific (except China)

☐ Other:

Including yourself, how many people usually travel with you?

Your answer

What is the reason for most of your trips?

☐ Work

☐ Educational

☐ Leisure

☐ Others

What is your current employability status?

- ☐ Employed full time
- ☐ Employed part time
- ☐ Unemployed (looking for work)
- ☐ Unemployed (not looking for work)
- ☐ Student
- ☐ Retired

Approximately, what is your annual income? (in USD)

- ☐ Below \$30,000
- ☐ \$30,000-\$100,000
- ☐ \$100,000 or above

Which type of accommodation do you prefer?

- ☐ Budget accommodation (eg. Hostels, budget hotels)
- ☐ Non Budget accommodation (eg. mid to high end, luxury hotels)
- ☐ No preference

Which factors affect your preference for a budget accommodation?

- ☐ Current economic conditions
- ☐ Seasonal fluctuations in hotel rates
- ☐ Exchange rates
- ☐ Other: _____

Are you currently a customer with Marriott Hotel?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

Submit

Clear form

4.2 Questionnaire for Marriott Customers

From a scale of 1-5, with 1 being least and 5 being most, how likely are you to rebook a stay at a Marriott hotel in the future?

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

If your answer to the above is "No" , please explain why.

Your answer _____

Which brands of Marriott Hotel have you stayed at?

- ☐ Ritz Carlton / St. Regis/ JW Marriott
- ☐ Marriott Hotels/ Sheraton/ Westin
- ☐ Courtyard/ Fairfield Inn & Suites/ Moxy Hotels
- ☐ Others

Which region of Marriott Hotel did you stay at?

- ☐ Asia Pacific (except China)
- ☐ Europe
- ☐ USA
- ☐ China
- ☐ Others

Please rank the personalised services according to the ones you feel are most important in your stay.

	Very important	Important	Neutral	Not important	Not important at all
Personalised room settings (eg. lighting, temperature, fragrance)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Personalised room service (eg. suggestions based on AI)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Personal concierge services (eg. wellness, private transport, event planning)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Personalised dining experience (eg. customised meals for dietary needs)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Service delivery quality	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

On a scale of 1 to 5, with 1 being least preferred and 5 being most preferred, Do you prefer hotels that offer technology features in your stay? (eg. smart room controls, mobile check ins, speedy internet, ai personalised suggestions)

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

On a scale of 1 to 5, with 1 being most dissatisfied and 5 being most satisfied. Based on your previous stays in Marriott hotels, how would you rate your satisfaction?

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Are you currently a Marriott Hotel loyalty member? If so, what is your loyalty tier?

- ☐ No, I am not a member
- ☐ Silver elite
- ☐ Gold elite
- ☐ Platinum elite
- ☐ Titanium elite
- ☐ Ambassador elite

Are you aware of Marriott hotel's sustainability initiatives?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

Would you be interested to participate in a 90 minute online Focus group discussion? The topic of discussion emerging travel trends and destination hotspots and decision to book a hotel.
(\$25 USD PayPal voucher will given as additional reward upon completion)

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

Submit

Clear form

4.3 Questionnaire for Non-Marriott Customers

From a scale of 1-5, with 1 being least and 5 being most, how likely are you to book a stay at a Marriott hotel in the future?

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

If your answer to the above is "No", please explain why.

Your answer

Please rank the personalised services according to the ones you feel are most important in your stay.

	Very important	Important	Neutral	Not important	Not important at all
Personalised room settings (eg. lighting, temperature, fragrance)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Personalised room service (eg. suggestions based on AI)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Personal concierge services (eg. wellness, private transport, event planning)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Personalised dining experience (eg. customised meals for dietary needs)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Service delivery quality	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Are you aware of Marriott hotel's sustainability initiatives?

☐ Yes

☐ No

On a scale of 1 to 5, with 1 being least preferred and 5 being most preferred, Do you prefer hotels that offer technology features in your stay? (eg. smart room controls, mobile check ins, speedy internet, ai personalised suggestions)

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Would you be interested to participate in a 90 minute online Focus group discussion? The topic of discussion emerging travel trends and destination hotspots and decision to book a hotel.
(\$25 USD PayPal voucher will given as additional reward upon completion)

☐ Yes

☐ No

Submit

Clear form

4.4 Interest form for Focus Group Discussion

Focus group discussion form

Thank you for showing interest in participating in the focus group discussion of emerging travel trends and destination hotspots and decision to book a hotel. By filling up this form, you agree to participate and be part of the online focus group that will span at most 90 minutes. The details will be sent to you shortly within 2 working days after filling up the form. The \$25 USD PayPal voucher will be sent to you through email after your participation in the focus group discussion is completed. Thank you.

bryonwongultra@gmail.com [Switch account](#)



Not shared

Name

Your answer

Email

Your answer

Submit

Clear form

5. Proposed timeline

The project is expected to start on 1 March 2025 and end on 10 August 2025, within a 6-month window.

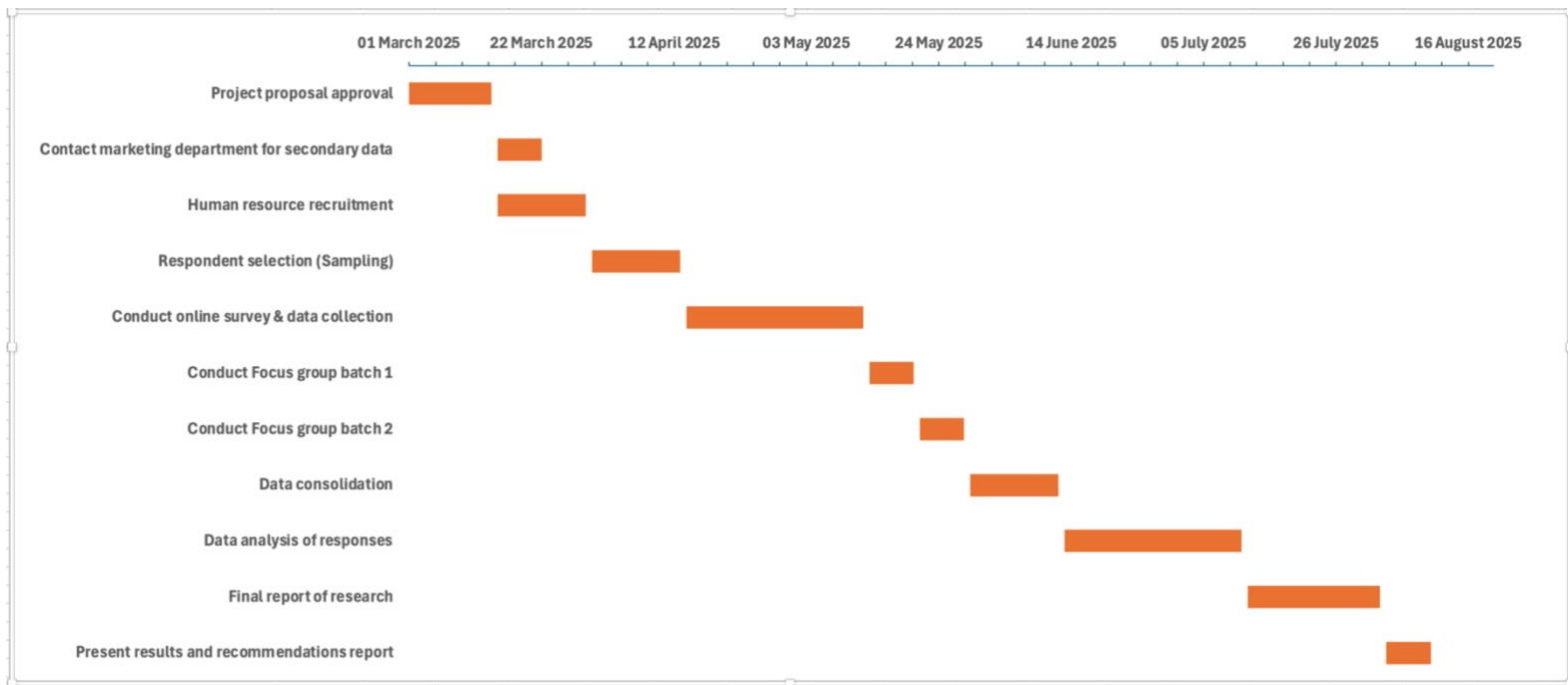


Table 22: Gantt chart of project timeline

6. Budget

Activity description	Cost in USD
Online survey incentives	\$7000 (first 700 participants)
Online focus group incentives + Moderator cost	\$5500 (\$2500 for 100 participants + \$3000 for moderators)
Administrative fee	\$50,000
Data collection (Marketing and preparation)	\$300,000
Data analyst	\$200,000
Miscellaneous expenses	\$50,000
Total	\$612,500

7. Recommendations

Marriott International can look into features that competitors have an edge over. Due to recent rise in technology, Marriott can look into further optimising its operation speed through increased AI adoption. Marriott can also expand into niche markets such as pet friendly hotels, and micro hotels in dense cities can also be a new market for Marriott.

8. Appendix

1. Marriot revenue breakdown 2016-2023 - <https://businessquant.com/marriott-international-revenue-breakdown#:~:text=The%20majority%20of%20Marriott%20International's,International's%20properties%20in%20US%20&%20Canada.>
2. How many hotel customer in the U.S.A stayed at Marriot hotels before <https://www.statista.com/forecasts/1335722/marriott-hotels-brand-profile-in-the-united-states#:~:text=All%20in%20all%2C%2019%20percent,the%20United%20States%20use%20Marriott.>
3. Marriott Loyalty member tier <https://www.marriott.com/loyalty/member-benefits.mi>
4. Marriot revenue breakdown 2024 <https://marriott.gcs-web.com/annual>
5. How economic factors affect the hotel industry- <https://skift.com/2025/01/03/how-does-the-economy-impact-travel/#:~:text=Hotel%20Industry:%20The%20hotel%20sector,and%20revenue%20per%20available%20room.>
6. Galiano, J. (no date) What to consider beyond "how long should a focus group last?", Nottingham Spirk. Available at: <https://www.nottinghamspirk.com/musings/how-long-should-a-focus-group-last>
7. Guest personalised services in hotels - <https://www.mews.com/en/blog/personalization-in-hospitality>

9. Fulfilment of proposal requirements

Requirements	Section
Provide a full summary of the research brief, including the aims of the research.	Executive Summary
Demonstrate an understanding of the market or business context as well as any other publically available research done in this area.	1
Detail how the fieldwork would be conducted, i.e. face-to-face, telephone, online, focus groups, mixed-mode etc.	2,3
Explain the proposed sampling method as well as other sampling methods considered, including details on any sampling frame to be used.	3
Detail the information that would be gathered and collected by the research.	3
Explain how you would use any customer or operational data supplied to you by the client.	3
Describe what multivariate analysis techniques you propose and how these would help the client's research aims. (You are not required to actually conduct any analysis.)	4
Detail the proposed sample size necessary to construct confidence intervals around the survey estimates.	3
An appropriate questionnaire which would capture suitable data to perform the proposed multivariate analysis. (You are not required to actually run the questionnaire in practice.)	8
Proposed further research, i.e. include ideas for how some business or organisational objectives might be helped by further and different research.	7

